

3.3 Preparation for the speaking test

Picture selection in Task A

To ensure students have access to the full range of assessment criteria and the opportunity to score well in Task A, it is essential they select a picture that follows the guidelines below.

The picture **MUST** contain the following elements:

- people (at least two people)
- objects (in the background)
- interactions (showing what people are doing).

The picture must not contain any text that could support students in their responses.

For examples of pictures, please see the *Sample Assessment Materials* document, which is available on our website.

Teachers/examiners may not practise Task A with their students using the picture they will be using in the test. They may use other pictures on the same topic but they may not practise or rehearse using the student's chosen picture.

Notification of Task A focus

Students must provide a copy of the picture for the teacher/examiner in advance of the test.
